

Zixiao “Marshall” Ma

Job Title: Level Designer

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INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCES

NetEase Game | Game System Designer Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Participated in system design and feature iteration for the overseas version of Revelation Mobile.
- Configured monetization events, managed localized content, and conducted feature testing.
- Collaborated with programmers, artists, QA testers, and overseas publishing teams to support version development and delivery.
- Gained hands-on experience with the full development pipeline of a large-scale live-service MMORPG, from design and implementation to release and operation.

LEVEL DESIGN PROJECTS

Decaran Become Human | Level Designer Feb 2026 – May 2026

- Independently designed and developed a complete quest level in Starfield using the Creation Kit.
- Implemented level logic, enemy encounters, and event-triggering systems.
- Responsible for spatial layout, exploration pacing, quest flow, and environmental storytelling.

The Way of Water | Level Designer Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Independently designed and developed a Half-Life 2 FPS level using Hammer Editor.
- Designed player guidance, combat pacing, and sightline composition while exploring Half-Life 2's physics-based gameplay and water mechanics.

GAME DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCES

FLING | Designer, Level Designer Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

- Collaborated with a four-person team to develop a Celeste-inspired 2D platformer in Unity.
- Designed core gameplay mechanics and levels and participated in public playtesting.

Hamster Ballin' | Level Designer, Camera Designer Feb 2026 – May 2026

- Collaborated with a 42-person team to develop a UE5 kart racing game inspired by Mario Kart.
- Designed racetracks and camera systems, working closely with programmers and artists to iterate on level design and optimize the player experience.

Big Fishing Boom | Independent Boardgame Designer 2024 - Now

- Designed an original card-based board game showcased at the SHM Board Game Expo in Shanghai.
- Collaborate with publishers and commercial partners for further development.

EDUCATION

Southern Methodist University Guildhall Dallas, USA Aug 2025-May 2027

- *Digital Game Development Level Design Master*

Zhejiang Sci-Tech University Hangzhou, China Sept 2021-Jun 2025

- *Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Technology Bachelor*

SKILLS

Game Engine: UE5, Unity, PICO-8, Hammer Editor, Creation Kit, Radiant

Digital Design Software: Photoshop, Illustrator, Aseprite, Ableton, 3DS Max

Programming Languages: C, C++, C#, Lua, Python, Java, Assembler